“He who asks the questions leads the way,” as Socrates may have said – and one thing is certain: in a job interview you can definitely use your own questions to test whether the position really is up your alley. Questions are an opportunity to dive deeper and, maybe, to extract information from between the lines, which your interviewer isn’t particularly keen to give away. If you’ve already done some careful research, you shouldn’t need to ask anything about the size of the company, the number of sites it has abroad or what products it sells. Don’t waste what precious time you have on questions that you could also Google or, worse still, that have already been answered during your interview. Instead, it makes sense to think in advance about the daily routine at the company, working together with colleagues and your career opportunities – but also about the issues that your employer will face in the future. Here are a few ideas on what to ask:

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What do I ask now?

The final quarter of your interview is set aside for your own questions. Here is how to prepare a good set – and which ones you can definitly leave at home.

A typical day at work and the team

What would a typical day/week at work look like for someone in this job?
What do you see as the biggest challenges in the position?
May I come and see my future workplace?
How many days a month would I spend traveling on average?
What are the rules on working hours?
What else should I learn about before I start?
Who in the team can help me with my duties?

Career opportunities

Why has the post become vacant?
Where are employees who used to work in this department now?
What challenges could I expect in my first three months on the job?
How do you support your staff?
Is there a budget for professional education and development?
What training have team members done most recently?
What targets should I hit with my team in my first year?
What would the perfect candidate for this position do in order to put in an exceptional performance?

The future of the employer

What challenges is your company facing at the moment?
Are you looking to branch out into other areas of business?
How important are New Work and diversity to your company?
Where should the company be in five years?

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